

For Enjay, Open Source Technology is a Way of Life

Open source is the technology of the masses. Don't believe it? Well, read this article and you will be forced to acknowledge that open source technology is making deeper inroads into the market with every passing day. An entirely open source-based company, Enjay IT Solutions, has built itself a reputation in the OSS domain.

Diksha P Gupta delves deep into the makings of this success story during a conversation with **Limesh Parekh, CEO, Enjay IT Solutions Ltd.** Read on...



Limesh Parekh, CEO, Enjay IT Solutions Ltd

Open source technology is clearly the order of the day. Right from being the technology based on which some of the biggest companies are powering the world of e-commerce, open source technology has managed to make a place for itself across other segments too. Companies that had faith in the world of open source during the early days are enjoying the fruits of being early adopters. Enjay IT Solutions is one such company that chose to go against the tide since the very beginning. It went in for open source technology, even when most of the tech world couldn't see beyond proprietary technologies.

Enjay is known for its 'E-nnovative' solutions for the Indian SME market. The company offers smart enterprise-class storage, telephony, desktop, cloud and

monitoring solutions. Limesh Parekh, chief executive officer, Enjay, describes his tryst with open source as an interesting one. He says, "One of the biggest reasons for us choosing open source technology is its technological stability and framework. It is much easier to develop on open source projects and create the value addition on them compared to developing something from scratch. For us, open source technology is a way of life. It is a well thought of decision. We analysed each aspect around the technology and then came to the conclusion that there's nothing better than open source. Open source technologies are more mature, and their biggest advantage is that they offer much better financial incentives for both the sellers and buyers."

The world has been in love with open source technology for its robust, state-of-the-art and mature technology framework. According to Parekh, "Enjay also develops connectors for various open source projects. These include a Sugar-Asterisk connector, a Sugar-Outlook connector and a Sugar De-duplication connector. This helps us take advantage of the popularity of the open source projects and, at the same time, provide value addition for our clients."

However, Enjay has faced its share of hardships while dealing with the anti-open source perceptions. Parekh explains, "One of the most difficult aspects of open source technology is marketing it. Moreover, often, open source projects do have some bugs, which we have to first fix before going to market. But the benefits of open source, including that of customisation, are way too many for the companies to ignore."

Awareness is the key...

Even if current awareness levels about open source technology have improved compared to the early days, one can really not claim that these are high enough. Convincing SMBs to try out open source solutions proves to be quite a task for Enjay. Parekh explains, "It is difficult but not impossible. There are two factors operating in such situations. The first is how profitable your proposal is for